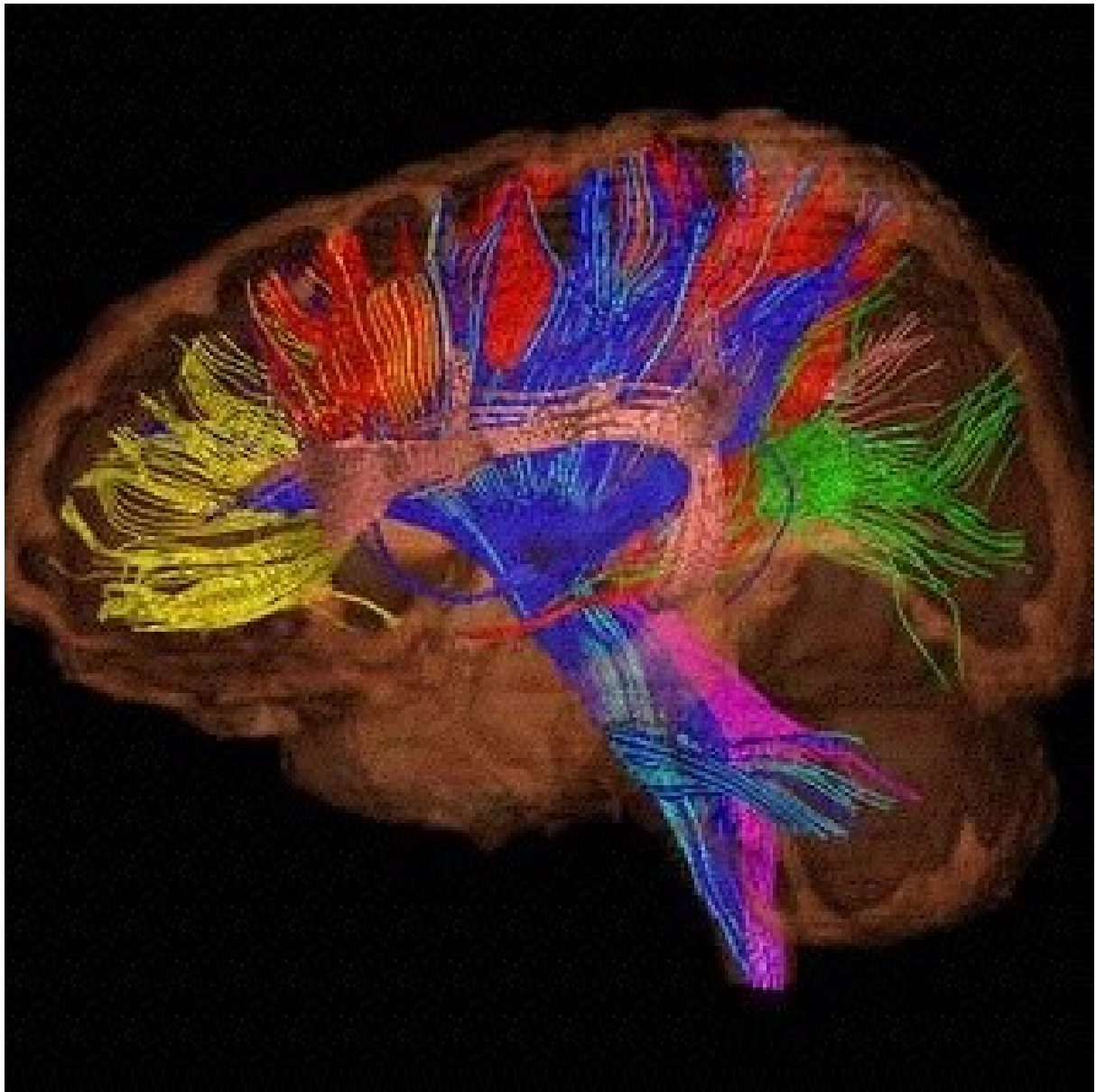


MSc by Research in Integrative Neuroscience
Programme Handbook 2023/2024



Cover photo by Ian Deary: Diffusion Tensor MRI of the White Matter Tracts of the Human Brain

Every effort has been made to ensure that the information contained in this handbook was correct at the time of publication. However, the handbook does not form part of any contract between the University and a student or applicant and must be read in conjunction with the terms and conditions of admission set out in the University of Edinburgh's annual Postgraduate Prospectus and the University of Edinburgh's Taught Assessment Regulations.

The contents of this handbook apply to the session year stipulated. The University may make changes to the programme for future sessions.

This handbook does not supersede the University Regulations.

If you require this document or any of the internal University of Edinburgh online resources mentioned in this document in an alternative format please contact Debbie Grahames at Neuroscience.MSc@ed.ac.uk.

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1. WELCOME

Dear MScR Students,

Welcome to the programme and to an exciting year of neuroscience ahead of you. You should find all of the necessary information about the programme in this handbook. Any changes will be announced in Learn and through your University email, so do not forget to check these daily. If you have any queries or problems regarding your studies, please contact the Programme Administrator (or your Student Advisor). We wish you all a very successful year.



Prof Emma Wood
(Programme Co-Directors)



Prof Karen Horsburgh

1.1 CONTACTS

Programme Directors and Cohort Leads:

- Prof Emma Wood - Emma.Wood@ed.ac.uk
- Prof Karen Horsburgh - Karen.Horsburgh@ed.ac.uk

The Programme Directors are responsible for the smooth running of the Integrative Neuroscience Programme, including responsibility for the admissions to the programme, plus coordination of teaching, examinations, programme evaluation, and curriculum development.

The Cohort Lead is a member of academic staff from your matriculated School/Deanery, who is allocated to you at the beginning of the academic year.

Cohort leads for the taught phase of your degree: Emma Wood and Karen Horsburgh

In addition, the cohort lead can provide one-to-one support to:

- Help you to review your academic progress.
- Provide opportunities for you to reflect on how your learning can help you pursue your future development.

They can also advise on academic matters such as course choices in your degree programme.

Programme Administrator:

- Ms Debbie Grahames - Neuroscience.MSc@ed.ac.uk
Debbie is based in the Biomedical Teaching Organisation (BMTO) main office located at Doorway 3, Teviot Place (central campus). Office hours: 9:00am – 5:00pm

Student Advisor:

Your Student Advisor is here to support you throughout your time with the University of Edinburgh. The Student Advisor for Integrative Neuroscience is;

- David Scanlon – davidscanlonSABMS@ed.ac.uk

David will be able to provide information on;

- Wellbeing
- University central services
- Accessing support through University services and external agencies
- Applying for Special Circumstances. They can also provide you with a statement to support your application
- Applying for a coursework Extensions
- University policies and regulations
- Requesting letters and official documents

It is your responsibility to inform your Student Advisor immediately of any problems that are interfering with your coursework or progress through the Programme, including any religious or medical requirements that might affect your participation in any aspect of the Programme.

Senior Personal Tutor and BMS Postgraduate Director:

- Dr Kim Picozzi - Kim.Picozzi@ed.ac.uk

College of Medicine and Veterinary Medicine Graduate School

The University of Edinburgh
The Chancellor's Building
49 Little France Crescent
Edinburgh EH16 4SB

Hours: 9-5pm, Mon-Fri

Website: <http://www.ed.ac.uk/medicine-vet-medicine>

In cases of emergency students should dial 2222. This number is only available from the University internal telephone system. Students in Residences or those calling from a mobile phone should dial (0131) 650 2257.

Students who experience a crisis outside normal working hours can contact the University for support through the University Security 24/7 contact number +44 (0)131 650 2257.

<https://www.ed.ac.uk/contacts/out-of-hours-support>

1.2 AIMS AND OBJECTIVES OF THE PROGRAMME

Our aim in the MSc by Research in Integrative Neuroscience is to prepare students for a career in Neuroscience research.

Objectives:

- To provide an overview of Neuroscience as a discipline
- To provide experience and exposure to contemporary methods and techniques used in Neuroscience research
- To provide instruction in good laboratory practice
- To encourage a quantitative approach to the investigation of problems in Neuroscience
- To provide training and practice in analysis and oral presentation of scientific data and research papers
- To provide opportunities to design, execute and report original research
- To provide an opportunity to attend a scientific meeting

2. GENERAL INFORMATION

2.1 PROGRAMME REQUIREMENTS

The requirements of the curriculum for the degree are set out in:

- The appropriate Degree Programme Table
- The programme handbook
- The assessment section for the programme, which is published in the University Degree Regulations and Programmes of Study

The University Degree Regulations and Programmes of Study set out University-wide and programmes specific regulations: <http://www.drps.ed.ac.uk/23-24/>

The Taught Assessment Regulations set minimum requirements and standards for students and staff, expressing in practical form the academic goals and policies of the University: https://www.ed.ac.uk/sites/default/files/atoms/files/2023_taught.pdf

2.2 EXPECTATIONS OF YOU ON PROGRAMME

The MSc Integrative Neuroscience Programme is a full year programme, which runs from September 11th, 2023 until August 31st, 2024. **You are required to be available in person as follows:**

- Taught element of programme: **September 18th, 2023 - December 15th, 2023.**
- Research element of programme: **January 15th, 2024 – August 31st, 2024.**

Students may take holidays (up to 2 weeks) as long as these are discussed and agreed with your project supervisor and programme directors. All students who wish to take longer than one week should complete a leave of absence form (posted on LEARN). For those students on a Tier 4 visa you need to make sure you comply with immigration requirements and should check with student immigration and agree leave.

As a student on the MSc by Research in Integrative Neuroscience it is expected that you:

- **Attend** all prescribed lectures and classes or let the programme administrator know if you are unable to attend; repeated non-engagement may result in an escalation process.
- **Engage** with your project(s) and meet with your primary supervisor regularly (at least fortnightly or as agreed).
- **Check** your university email on a daily basis.
- **Read and respond** to administrator, supervisor or programme director emails promptly as required.
- **Comply** with the formal rules and regulations of the programme, the school and the university.
- **Conduct** yourself to the highest ethical and professional standard at all times.
- **Alert your student advisor** if you have any issues as soon as possible and arrange to discuss.

2.3 UNIVERSITY FACILITIES

2.3.1 NEW STUDENT GUIDE

The [New Students website](#) is aimed at all new students (UK/rest of EU and international) and provides guidance on a range of necessary actions such as obtaining a visa, securing accommodation and completing the process of registration, as well as useful advice on money, health, orientation events and student support.

2.3.2 COMPUTING FACILITIES

All students at the University of Edinburgh are registered with Computing Services and assigned a username, password and an electronic mailbox. Email is the formal means of communication by the University with its students. **Many announcements about the course are communicated by e-mail, so it is essential for you to check your e-mail at least once a day.** There are computing facilities in the Main Library in George Square, on the Ground and First Floor of 1 George Square, and the main open access computer suite is adjacent to the Hugh Robson Building. Some common software packages for word processing, spreadsheets, databases, statistics, graphics and presentation are site licensed and accessible via the local Edinburgh network.

2.3.3 LIBRARY FACILITIES

The University Library is a network of resources located throughout Edinburgh. The Main University Library is in George Square and it is here that you can register for access to ATHENS, which, provides web-browser access to databases of medical/scientific references, citations and abstracts.

2.3.4 TEACHING LOCATIONS

Most teaching is taught in the Central Area but some teaching takes place at the Royal Infirmary at Little France, Edinburgh BioQuarter.

2.3.5 LEARN

The programme is supported by the University's LEARN virtual learning environment and the MScR Neuroscience programme has its own LEARN page. Timetables, course information, lecture slides and provisional grades will be available here. Support for assessments will also be given and you will submit your assignments to drop-boxes via LEARN. The MScR Neuroscience page can be found within the Blackboard LEARN platform on MyEd.

2.3.6 GRADUATIONS

Please refer to the [Graduations](#) Website for the most up to date information on graduations.

2.3.7 GETTING HELP WITH INFORMATION SERVICES

The IS Helpline provides a first point of contact for enquiries relating to library, computing services and online learning. The helpline is available around the clock with 24/7 cover.

More details of the IS Helpline service is available on the IS website: <https://www.ed.ac.uk/information-services/help-consultancy/contact-helpline>

Please contact using your University email account to ensure your enquiry is prioritised.

Our computer support services, training opportunities and library resources will help you make the most of your study time.

Guidance on digital tools for your studies, how to develop your digital skills, and how to stay safe while studying online: Using [Online Learning Tools](#).

[EdHelp](#) gives a single point of contact for help with student services. This includes questions about library, computing services and online learning. Please contact using your University email account to help us process your enquiry.

2.4 STUDENT-STAFF LIAISON COMMITTEES (SSLC)

We will ask for students to volunteer to take on the role of student representatives (reps) at the start of the programme in September and the names will be circulated to the rest of the class. Edinburgh University Students' Association (EUSA) coordinates the reps and provides training and support for them. The student reps can raise academic, welfare, resource, and any other issues of general and particular concern on behalf of class members individually or as a group, either informally with the Programme Directors or through the formal structures and procedures outlined in the programme handbook. There will be at least two Student-Staff Liaison Committee (SSLC) meetings during the year. The Deanery of Biomedical Sciences also invites volunteers to represent postgraduates at the Deanery level.

You can also contact the Edinburgh University Students' Association (EUSA) directly by email at: postgrad@eusa.ed.ac.uk.

3. SUMMARY OF PROGRAMME STRUCTURE

This is a brief summary of the course structure; more detailed information can be found in the Programme Content section on page 19.

The MScR Integrative Neuroscience Programme is full-time and runs from September 11th, 2023 until August 31st, 2024. Graduation is normally in November/December following completion.

3.1 SEMESTER 1 (SEPTEMBER TO DECEMBER 2023)

The first semester features the 'taught' component of the programme comprising lectures on many different areas of neuroscience, specialist electives, and core skills training. During this semester you will cover the following:

- Introduction to the programme and introductory core skills in week 1, followed by experimental

design and statistics and other core skills taught throughout semester 1 and for part of semester 2 (Core skills training).

- A series of nine 'themed week' lectures (Review of Neuroscience course) starting in week 2
- A choice of one of four Elective courses (introduction in week 1, electives start in week 2).
- MScR Integrative Neuroscience residential trip to Fribush outdoor centre (week 6) – students will normally attend over 3 days e.g. Monday-Wednesday, Tuesday-Thursday or Wednesday-Friday. Accommodation, food, travel, and activity costs are covered by the programme.
- Animal research ethics training and Home Office Licence Training Courses and assessments required for research using animals.
- From Week 1 onwards, you should contact potential supervisors to arrange your research project(s) which start in January 2024. You will receive instructions and guidance on this at an introductory session in Week 1.

During semester 1 the following assessments will be due:

- Review of Neuroscience in-course assessment 1 – Group poster and presentation on a paper relevant to a themed week. This will take place during the programme trip to the Fribush Outdoor Centre during Week 6.
- Review of Neuroscience in-course assessment 2 – a) News and Views article and b) Lay summary based on a paper relevant to a themed week (due 18th Dec 2023).
- Elective assessments – (details and dates provided in elective course descriptions on Page 23. Final assessments for electives will normally be during week 13 (last submission date 15th December).
- ScotPiL Home office Licence Ethics and Legislation (everyone); additional modules and assessments as required for your project (various dates – see LEARN)

3.2 RESEARCH PROJECT 1 PERIOD (JANUARY 15TH TO APRIL 18TH 2024)

By the end of semester 1, you will have arranged your first 12-week project. The research element of Project 1 will run from 15th January – 5th April, 2024. During this period there will also be an opportunity to attend additional core skills sessions.

During project 1 period the following assessments will be due:

- Research Proposal: related to the research topic of project 1 (due 18th March, 2024)
- Poster and oral presentation: on research conducted during project 1 (18th April, 2024).

3.3 BNA MEMBERSHIP AND FENS FORUM SUMMER CONFERENCE

As part of the programme, students are enrolled as members of the British Neuroscience Association and are supported to attend a neuroscience meeting as part of the MSc programme. In 2024 this conference will be the FENS Forum held in Vienna, Austria from 25th-29th June 2024.

Web link: <https://fensforum.org/>

We will pay for and arrange your conference registration fee, accommodation and return travel to the conference. You will be able to claim expenses to cover food and travel whilst at the conference (budget to be confirmed but must fall within the rules of the [University's Expenses Policy](#)). If you would prefer to attend an alternative neuroscience conference, please contact the programme administrator in the first instance with details of the conference and justification for attending this rather than the FENS forum.

3.4 RESEARCH PROJECT 2 PERIOD (APRIL 22ND TO AUGUST 31ST 2024)

Between April 22nd and the end of July you will undertake your second research project. This could be a new project (either in the same or a different research group as Project 1), or it could be a continuation of Project 1. The research element of the project will run from 22nd April 2– 19th July, 2024.

The following assessments related to project 2 will be due as follows:

- MSc Dissertation (due 5th August 2024)
- Oral Presentation of Dissertation Project (19th August 2024)

3.5 OPTIONAL SEMINARS & COURSES

3.5.1 RESEARCH SEMINARS

Research seminars by visiting speakers are held in Edinburgh throughout the year. The Seminar series of the Centre for Discovery Brain Sciences (CDBS) can be found here <https://www.ed.ac.uk/discovery-brain-sciences/seminars>. The programmes for each of the many seminar series related to neuroscience will be distributed through Edinburgh Neuroscience. Within the constraints of their practical work, students are encouraged to attend as many research seminars as possible to encourage a broader insight to different neuroscience research fields.

3.5.2 INSTITUTE OF ACADEMIC DEVELOPMENT (IAD)

MVM Research Masters students may also attend many of the courses provided through IAD. Available courses include: Searching Research Literature, Managing Bibliographies and Endnote, Time Management, Mind Mapping, Reading for Speed, Effective Writing.

Information on the courses and places available is regularly updated on the web at <http://www.ed.ac.uk/schools-departments/institute-academic-development/>. To request a place on one of these courses please follow the instructions on the web.

4. SUMMARY OF ASSESSMENTS

The MSc Programme has formal assessment amounting to 180 credits. The assessed pieces of work are summarised below by course title, with weightings and deadlines. All marks will be ratified by the MScR Integrative Neuroscience Exam Board, except the Neuroimaging elective (NEME11040) which will be ratified at the Deanery for Clinical Sciences Board.

More details of the assessments will be published on LEARN

Course (Credits)	Course Code & credits	Assessment Description	Weight	Deadline
TAUGHT ELEMENT OF PROGRAMME				
4.1 Review of Neuroscience	NEBM11018 20 credits	Group poster presentation (based on themed weeks)	40%	Semester 1, Week 6 at Fimbush (TBA)
		News & Views Lay Summary (both based on a different themed week)	48% 12%	18/12/23, 1pm
4.2 Elective courses (each student takes only one of the four elective courses)				
Neural dynamics	NEBM11017 20 credits	See elective information on Learn		
Neurodegeneration and Regeneration	NEBM11013 20 credits	See elective information on Learn		
Neurodevelopmental Disorders	NEBM11014 20 credits	See elective information on Learn		
Developmental Neurobiology	NEBM11015 20 credits	See elective information on Learn		
PROJECT 1 - RELATED ASSESSMENTS				
4.3 Research proposal	NEBM11007 20 credits	Research proposal (related to project 1)	100%	18/03/24, 1pm
4.4 Presenting Neuroscience Research Data	NEBM11005 20 credits	Poster Oral presentation of poster (both based on research project 1)	80% 20%	18/04/24,
PROJECT 2 – RELATED ASSESSMENTS				
4.5 Masters Dissertation (Neuroscience)	NEBM11002 80 credits	Written dissertation (based on research project(s))	100%	05/08/24, 1pm
4.6 Research Training	NEBM11016 20 credits	Oral presentation of dissertation	75%	19/08/24
		Supervisor report - Project 2 (based on engagement, skill development, contribution to discussions and record keeping)	25%	19/08/24

5. PROGRAMME ASSESSMENTS - GENERAL INFORMATION

5.1 DEADLINES AND WORD COUNTS

If you are late in submitting a course assignment, you should aim to submit it as soon as possible after the deadline letting the administrator know and, if appropriate, discuss with your student advisor the possibility of applying for an extension or Special Circumstances (see Section 5.5).

If assessed coursework is submitted late without an agreed extension to the deadline for an accepted good reason, it will be recorded as late and a penalty will be exacted. For coursework that is a substantial component of the course and where the submission deadline is more than two weeks after the issue of the work to be assessed, that penalty is a reduction of the mark by 5% of the maximum obtainable mark per calendar day (e.g. a mark of 65% on the common marking scale would be reduced to 60% up to 24 hours later). This applies for up to seven calendar days (or to the time when feedback is given, if this is sooner), after which a mark of zero will be given. The original unreduced mark will be recorded by the School and the student informed of it.

Word counts need to be strictly adhered to for all written work including News and Views and Lay abstract, Research Proposal and Masters' Dissertation. It is **YOUR responsibility** to ensure you follow BMTO's word count policy. (Appendix 3)

5.2 LEARNING ADJUSTMENTS

Learning adjustments are amendments to your course of study which enable you to participate fully in your education. You can now request this extra time via your Disability Support page using the Extra Time Adjustment (ETA) Tool.

The types of learning adjustment that can be requested via the ETA are:

- Extra time on a submission;
- Extra time for a proof-reader.

If you need to access any other type of learning adjustment (for example, extra time on an exam) please contact your Programme administrator or directors.

If you believe that you have a valid reason to have a Schedule of Adjustments in place and wish to be considered for such support, please approach the Disability Learning Support Service with supporting documentation.

5.3 WHEN THINGS GO WRONG

There are many factors which can have an impact on your academic performance.

If a short-term acute event means you know you won't be able to submit a written assessment on time, you can apply for a short extension in advance of the coursework deadline. If you feel that something beyond your control is having a negative effect on your studies, you should talk to your Student Advisor about submitting for Special Circumstances.

At the University of Edinburgh we are committed to supporting you during your studies and want to make sure there's nothing preventing you from succeeding in your assessments.

We know that sometimes things can happen in your life, which are beyond your control, but that you feel may have an adverse impact on your academic performance.

Therefore, we have a dedicated Extensions and Special Circumstances (ESC) service so that you can apply for **an extension when** you need a short amount of time to complete an assessment (for a maximum of three calendar days) **or special circumstances** (when circumstances have meant a significant impact on your performance, or resulted in non-attendance or non-submission for an assessment), when you need to.

5.4 EXTENSIONS OF PROGRAMME OF STUDY

In exceptional circumstances, a student may apply through the supervisor or school postgraduate director to the College for an extension and it may be authorised by the College if there is good reason ([PG DRPS 34](#)).

Reasons for an extension might include circumstances where progress has been hampered by unforeseen difficulties with facilities or equipment or in obtaining or analysing data and hence completion of the studies has been delayed. A request for an extension cannot be based solely on the need for more time to complete.

For further guidance on how to apply and what types of documents to provide as evidence students should refer to the [Extensions and Special Circumstance Service webpage](#). It is advised that students consult their Student Advisor when completing the application.

5.5 EXTENSIONS AND SPECIAL CIRCUMSTANCES

You can submit your application via MyEd. The system will allow you to select a single course or piece of coursework, or to select several assignments across different courses, all in one application.

You should submit your application 2-3 weeks before the assessment is due. The Extensions and Special Circumstances team are here to help, and you can contact them directly with any questions about your application*. The team aim to respond to you within two working days.

Your Student Support staff (SSO) (BMTOPGstudentsupport@ed.ac.uk) in your School is your first point of contact should you wish to discuss your circumstances with them, access wider support from the University, and if you need help submitting your application.

*ESC email: escteam@ed.ac.uk

[Extensions and Special Circumstances Service | The University of Edinburgh](#)

Exceptionally, students may bring information on special circumstances to the attention of Conveners of Boards of Examiners via their Student Advisor or Programme Director at any time. If a student's ability to perform has been affected by a Special Circumstance, Boards of Examiners have Special Circumstances Committees to consider individual cases.

The Biomedical Sciences process for applying for Special Circumstances is available at [Assessment Support | The University of Edinburgh](#)

5.6 INTERRUPTIONS OF STUDY

Sometimes you may need to have time away from the University or from your studies. If you are temporarily unable to engage with your studies, you can apply for an authorised interruption of study. An interruption involves taking a complete break from study for an agreed period of time, usually for up to one academic year. Further guidance is available here

Taking an authorised interruption of study may have financial and visa implications. If you return to study in the next academic session, be aware that tuition fees increase every year. As such you may be charged a higher fee on your return to study. Further information is available [here](#).

5.7 WITHDRAWAL AND EXCLUSION

Any student may withdraw permanently from their programme of study at any point in the year. Students may be excluded for unsatisfactory academic progress. The procedure is described in the [Withdrawal and Exclusion from Studies](#) policy.

5.8 POSTGRADUATE COMMON MARKING SCHEME

Each course within the Biomedical Sciences programmes has its own specific criteria by which the assignments will be assessed; these will be highlighted to you within the assignment instructions. However, these criteria are determined with reference to the principles of the postgraduate common marking scheme (see appendix 5) which is outlined below. Remember, the pass mark is 40% for the award of credits, but 50% is the threshold for MSc level. It is also important to bear in mind that the University of Edinburgh's PG marking scheme may be different to the one your previous academic work has been assessed against, and the various grade boundaries may be significantly different. If you are worried about your marks and how they relate to your overall performance then contact your Student Advisor or the Cohort Lead for further advice.

The Postgraduate common marking scheme will be used for all assessment:

<https://www.ed.ac.uk/timetabling-examinations/exams/regulations/common-marking-scheme>

5.9 ASSESSMENT SUBMISSION

All assessments are to be submitted online via Learn – details will be communicated to you prior to the submission date. In some cases you may also be required to submit hard copies to the BMTO. All work must be covered by a Plagiarism Disclaimer: this will be in the form of an electronic declaration available within Learn at the point of submission.

5.9.1 ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT AND PLAGIARISM

Academic misconduct is any type of cheating that occurs in relation to a formal academic exercise. Academic misconduct includes plagiarism, collusion, falsification, deceit, cheating and person action. The University takes all reported incidences of academic misconduct seriously and seeks to ensure that they are dealt with efficiently and appropriately.

Guidance on understanding good academic practice and how to avoid plagiarism is available on the [Institute for Academic Development](#) website.

Information on academic misconduct and plagiarism, and how such cases will be handled, is given on the [Academic Services website](#).

All pieces of work must be accompanied by an electronically signed statement of originality – this will be completed on Learn as part of the submission process.

Students Registered with Professional Bodies

Any student who is registered with a professional body should be aware that all such organisations regard plagiarism as a serious professional concern. Any such student found to have committed plagiarism in an assessment at the University of Edinburgh may be reported to the relevant professional body.

Further procedures relating to late submissions are outlined in Regulation 28 of the [Taught Assessment Regulations](#).

5.10 MARKING AND FEEDBACK

Each course within the programme has its own specific criteria by which the assignments will be assessed; these will be highlighted to you within the assignment instructions. However, these criteria are determined with reference to the principles of the postgraduate common marking scheme.

All work is marked by members of academic staff at the University of Edinburgh or associated institutions. All assessed pieces of written work are either blind double marked (the second marker is not aware of the mark awarded by the first marker) or marked and then moderated by a member of the Programme team. Where blind double marking occurs, the mean of the two marks is used unless the two marks differ by more than 5% points. When this happens, the markers will be asked to discuss and agree a final mark. If they cannot agree, a third marker is used and the median mark taken.

Provisional marks (along with feedback) will be released to you so that you are able to gauge your progress; however, these marks are provisional and do not include any penalties or adjustments due to Special Circumstances and have no status until they have been considered and ratified by the Board of Examiners.

Feedback on assignments will be returned within 15 working days of the submission date. More time will be required for feedback on the dissertation, because this major piece of work requires more time to assess. These dates will be highlighted at the start of each course. Please note that the marks returned with the feedback are provisional.

Provisional marks are scrutinised and ratified by a Board of Examiners, including an External Examiner. Subsequent to ratification, students receive their published result in confidence via MyEd, within two working days of the relevant Exam Board. Final classifications will be published within two working days of the Final Exam Board date.

5.11 RETAINING AND SHARING STUDENT WORK

The University's student records retention schedule states that material which contributes to the final assessment of the degree, including Dissertations, should be retained in the School for a minimum 40 days after the Board of Examiners meeting which decides the overall classification or award of the degree, after which it will be destroyed. You will then be the only holder of the Dissertation.

However, if your dissertation and other course work has value for teaching or its contribution to knowledge, schools or subject groups may decide to retain it in house or transfer it to the Library. We

will remove your name from this work so that only the School can identify you as the author of the work through your UUN.

If your course work contains an assessment in the form of a video recording of you, then we will not be able to remove the identifiers and anonymise. This would then be retained and shown to future students if you give your consent, if not, it will be deleted.

In the case of group work, unless all members of the group give their consent, we will not retain and use the piece of work.

Course work that is non-confidential and with the student's consent, retained by the School for 10 years and made available online to other students.

Please refer to Taught Assessment Regulation 49

https://www.ed.ac.uk/sites/default/files/atoms/files/2023_taught.pdf

'Retention and destruction of material'

Further information about [Retention of Student Records](#)

5.12 BOARD OF EXAMINERS

The Board of Examiners typically meets twice a year, with the final Exam Board meeting in October. While we are able to release provisional marks in advance of the meetings you will not receive the final mark until after the meeting.

This Board is made up of a Convener, the External Examiner, the Programme Directors and academic staff involved in major sections of the Programme. The convener of the MScR Integrative Neuroscience exam board is Dr Dirk Sieger (email address)

An [External Examiner](#) is appointed for every MSc/MMedSci/MVetSci programme to moderate and adjudicate marking.

External Examiner Name: Prof Gernot Riedel

Institution: University of Aberdeen

Students MUST NOT make direct contact with their External Examiner; queries about the assessment process must be made to the Programme Team in the first instance.

5.13 REQUIREMENTS FOR FINAL AWARD

Please refer to the following regulation which concern awards, all of which can be found in the Taught Assessment Regulations with guidance on the Application of the regulations.

Please note that the Taught Assessment Regulations, and the DRPS are subject to review and therefore you should ensure that the regulations you are referring to are for the current year. If you are unsure, please ask a member of your programme team for assistance.

https://www.ed.ac.uk/sites/default/files/atoms/files/2023_taught.pdf

5.13.1 AWARD OF POSTGRADUATE MASTERS DEGREE - PASS, MERIT, AND DISTINCTION (TAUGHT ASSESSMENT REGULATIONS 57, 59, 60)

Students must achieve a weighted average mark of at least 50% in the in-course assessments (100 credits excluding the dissertation) and 50% in the Masters Dissertation in order to be awarded a pass.

Students must achieve a weighted average mark of at least 60% in the in-course assessment (100 credits excluding the dissertation) and 60% in the Masters Dissertation in order to be awarded a merit.

Students must achieve a weighted average mark of at least 70% in the in-course assessment (100 credits excluding the dissertation) and 70% in the Masters Dissertation in order to be awarded a distinction.

5.13.2 BORDERLINE CASES

Boards of Examiners must consider students whose marks are borderline for progression, award, or classification purposes. Boards of Examiners can also consider students whose marks are borderline for passing a course, where special circumstances apply. Borderline marks are defined as marks from two percentage points below the class or grade boundary up to the boundary itself, e.g. 58.00% to 59.99% for an undergraduate 2.1 classification or 38% to 39.99% for a pass in a course. Boards of Examiners and Progression Boards must use the University borderline definition and must not set and use a different definition.

When considering borderline cases for an award of Masters with a Pass, the Integrative Neuroscience Board of Examiners have stipulated that one of the following criteria must be met: a minimum of three 20 credit courses at $\geq 50\%$ or a weighted average mark for the whole 180 credit points of at least 50%.

When considering borderline cases for an award of Masters with Merit, the Integrative Neuroscience Board of Examiners have stipulated that one of the following criteria must be met: a minimum of three 20 credit courses at $\geq 60\%$ or a weighted average mark for the whole 180 credit points of at least 60%.

When considering borderline cases for an award of Masters with Distinction, the Integrative Neuroscience Board of Examiners have stipulated that one of the following criteria must be met: a minimum of three 20 credit courses at $\geq 70\%$ or a weighted average mark for the whole 180 credit points of at least 70%.

5.13.3 RESUBMISSION OF POSTGRADUATE DISSERTATIONS OR RESEARCH PROJECTS (TAUGHT ASSESSMENT REGULATION 58)

Students may be permitted to resubmit the dissertation or research project in line with the provisions of the Special Circumstances Policy where a student's performance in assessment has been affected by illness, accident or circumstances beyond their control. Students are also entitled to one resubmission of the dissertation or research project for postgraduate Masters programmes where the student has achieved a mark of 45 to 49% at the first attempt.

5.13.4 AWARD OF A DIPLOMA

Where a candidate fails to achieve 50% in the Dissertation, they may be eligible for a diploma. To obtain

a diploma they must achieve a mark between 40-49% in the dissertation (after resubmission, where eligible) and attain an average of at least 40% across the remaining 100 credits of study.

5.13.5 AWARD OF A CERTIFICATE

Where a candidate fails to achieve a mark of 40% or greater in the Dissertation, they may be eligible for a certificate. To obtain a certificate they must pass at least 40 credits with a mark of 40% or greater and attain an average of at least 40% across 60 credits of study.

5.14 PROCEDURE FOR APPEALS

An appeal is a request for a decision to be reviewed in relation to: marks, progression, degree classification, degree award, decisions of Student Discipline Officers or the Student Discipline Committee, decision of Fitness to Practise Panels, and exclusion decisions. If you are considering lodging an appeal, it is important that you act promptly. It is important to note that the appeal process cannot be used to challenge academic judgment, i.e. a judgment made about a matter where only the opinion of an academic expert will suffice. A student cannot submit an appeal simply because they believe that they deserve a better mark or different outcome. There are specific and fairly narrow grounds under which an appeal may be submitted. These are set out in the relevant university Student Appeal Regulations. It is recommended that you seek advice on the appeals process from The Advice Place.

Further guidance and information about the appeals procedure can be found here:

<https://www.ed.ac.uk/academic-services/students/appeals>

6 PROGRAMME CONTENT

6.1 SEMESTER 1 – TAUGHT ELEMENT OF PROGRAMME

The aims of the first semester are:

- to introduce you to many of the areas of neuroscience research and research methods currently ongoing at The University of Edinburgh through the themed weeks of the Review of Neuroscience course;
- to provide you core skills training in data analysis and statistics, as well as topics such as academic integrity, animal ethics and the 3Rs, how to consider research papers and what makes a good poster;
- to allow you to focus in depth on one neuroscience topic through your Elective course (choice of one from four);
- to provide training and assessments in animal research ethics and legislation, as well as training required by the Home Office for your research project.
- to promote a sense of programme community and belonging through cohort activities and the residential trip to Firbush Outdoor Centre

While some general introductory seminars are presented, the first semester is not intended to be a crash course in Neuroscience. The themed weeks and electives will introduce you to the broad range of neuroscience research in Edinburgh and allow you to arrange a research project that interests you.

See the advice for arranging your Research Projects in the Semester 2 section below.

6.1.1 SEMESTER 1 TIMETABLE

Your detailed week-to-week timetable for semester 1 can be found on the MScR Integrative Neuroscience Learn page on the course calendar.

Week 1 – Programme Introduction and Core skills

Weeks 2-5 and 7-11 – see table. NB Some Tuesday and Friday afternoons of these weeks may also be used for programme level sessions and ScotPIL training/assessments (see below).

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
9-12 Core skills	9-12 Themed week teaching	9-12 Themed week teaching	9-12 Themed week teaching	9-12 Themed week teaching
2-5 Electives	2-5	2-5 Programme-related teaching, animal research training and assessments, cohort lead activities	2-5 Electives	2-5

Week 6 – Fribush trip and Home Office Personal licence training

Week 12 – Elective course assessment preparation; Home office personal licence assessments

Week 13 – Elective course final assessments

6.1.2 [REVIEW OF NEUROSCIENCE \(NEBM11018\)](#) – 20 CREDITS.

Teaching for this course is through a series of “themed weeks,” each centred on a different topic or discipline in neuroscience research and will introduce you to a range of current areas of neuroscience research being pursued at Edinburgh. The aim is to provide an introduction to a broad range of neuroscience research fields, while helping you to develop your interest in possible topics for your research projects and to identify potential project supervisors.

The delivery of the themed week sessions is on Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday and Friday mornings of weeks 2-5 and Weeks 7-11 of the semester. Each week covers a different theme as follows:

Semester week	Dates	Theme	Theme organiser
2	w/b Mon 25 th Sept	Neural development	Tim Czopka
3	w/b Mon 2 nd Oct	Synaptic physiology	Mike Cousin, Michael Daw, Karen Smillie and Ian Duguid
4	w/b Mon 9 th Oct	Neuroinformatics	Angus Chadwick
5	w/b Mon 16 th Oct	Neurodegeneration and regeneration	Dirk Sieger & Julie Mazzolini
6	FIRBUSH TRIP Wed 25th – Fri 27th October		

7	w/b Mon 30 th Oct	C. elegans as a model system for neuroscience research	Maria Doitsidou & Sebastien Greiss
8	w/b Mon 6 th Nov	Neural circuits for cognition	Emma Wood
9	w/b Mon 13 th Nov	Motor disorders	Guisy Pennetta & Mandy Jackson
10	w/b Mon 20 th Nov	Sensory and control systems	Carole Torsney & Mike Ludwig
11	w/b Mon 27 th Nov	Cognitive Neurology	Thomas Bak

6.1.2.1 REVIEW OF NEUROSCIENCE ASSESSMENTS

There are two in-course assessments (ICA) associated with this course:

1. **Group poster and poster presentation (ICA1).** Students will be allocated to groups at the outset of the course and each group assigned a paper related to one of the first **two** themed weeks. Their task is to plan and make a poster which illustrates the main findings of the paper. To help prepare students, there will be a session on the Wednesday afternoon of Week 2 in which the task is introduced and there will be an interactive discussion on what makes a good poster. A further session will be held on the Wednesday afternoon of Week 4 during which each group will present a draft of their poster and feedback will be given. Each group will present their poster during the residential trip to the Fimbush Outdoor Centre during Week 6. Both the poster display and the poster presentation will be assessed.

Poster display (80% marks):

- The poster presentation of the research paper should include necessary background, aims/hypotheses/objectives, methodology, appropriate results, conclusions, limitations, future directions
- General appearance of the poster should be legible, concise, include visual enhancements, well organised and clear.
- Markers will spend approx. 15min at each poster and assess the group poster presentation
- Guidance on preparing a poster can be found in Appendix 4.

Oral presentation (20%):

- The group is allocated 10 min for the presentation and 5 min for discussion and questions.
- Work on the clarity of the presentation and the flow of information between students.
- Make sure you understand the subject matter and can respond to questions.

Additional information:

- The poster should be A0 and landscape.
- Printing can be done using the university graphics facilities at George Square or The King's Buildings.

- Up to £20 printing credit will be provided to one student/group in advance of this.
2. **'News and Views' Essay** (1,000 words maximum) and **Lay Summary** (200 words maximum) (ICA2). This is an individual piece of work, for which each student selects a paper published in *The Journal of Neuroscience* in the last 2 years, and writes a News and View style review, and a Lay summary as detailed below. The chosen paper must be related to one of the themed weeks taught during weeks 5, 7-11 of the semester. The themed week title should be included on the assignment coversheet. The word count excludes references and bibliography. The minimum font size should be 11pt.

The 'News and Views' essay (950-1000 words) should follow the format of a News and Views article in *Nature* and you should read some 'News and Views' articles beforehand. The 'news' should be highlighted in a succinct opening paragraph to attract the attention of those who are not experts in the field. This paragraph should indicate the significance of the new work. More detail and explanation of the study should follow. This should not only contain a summary of the original research but should put the research into context with other potentially contrasting findings. The article should conclude by commenting on the implications of the new findings and on future research directions. For the latter you should identify gaps that the research has left in our understanding and experiments suggested to resolve issues. You should include figures and tables where appropriate.

The Lay Summary (180-200 words), should provide a summary of the key questions addressed and the main findings of the paper, and be targeted at an intelligent and interested non-scientist. As each specialist term needs to be explained, it is often not possible to include more than two technical terms in the lay summary.

A Q&A session will be held in semester one (8th November 2023) to outline the task and provide guidance on the assessment. Students should prepare to select their paper and draft their essay and lay summary during semester one. The News and Views and Lay Summary are due on 18th December 2023 **J at 1pm**. An electronic copy must be submitted via LEARN.

6.1.2.2 REVIEW OF NEUROSCIENCE FEEDBACK

Formative feedback:

1. Oral feedback and discussion with peers and instructors on a draft version of the group poster (ICA1) (11th Oct 2023)
2. Oral feedback and discussion with peers and instructors on examples of news and views articles and lay summary in a workshop session (ICA2) (8th November 2023).

Summative feedback:

1. Written feedback on group poster and presentation (ICA1)
2. Written feedback on Lay Summary and News and Views essay (ICA2)

6.1.3 [CORE SKILLS \(BIME11068\)](#) 0 CREDITS

The core skills sessions will provide an introduction to different research approaches, experimental design and statistics. Several core skills sessions will run during week 1 of semester 1, after which the sessions will be on Monday mornings throughout semester 1 and for the first five weeks in semester 2. There is a separate LEARN page for this course (Core Skills Course (2023-2024) which you will be signed up to.

6.1.4 ELECTIVE COURSES (20 CREDITS)

See [DPT: Integrative Neuroscience \(MSc by Research\) \(Full-time\) \(PRMSCINEUS1F\)](#) for links to each elective with further information.

Electives run throughout the first semester on Monday and Thursday afternoons. Currently, four electives offering specialisation in the following topics are available. Students take one from the following:

- **Neural Dynamics (NEBM11017):** Prof Matthew Nolan & Prof Ian Duguid
- **Neurodegeneration and Regeneration (NEBM11013):** Dr Dirk Sieger & Dr Julie Mazzolini
- **Neurodevelopmental Disorders (NEBM11014):** Dr Sam Booker and Dr Sally Till
- **Developmental Neurobiology (NEBM11015):** Dr Tom Pratt & Dr Martine Manuel

Electives will be introduced in Week 1 on the afternoon of Monday 18th September. You will choose one of the four electives above. These will be allocated on a first come first served basis in a sign-up via LEARN available from **Wednesday 20th of September, at 13:00.**

Assessments vary depending on which elective is taken. Instructions will be provided by the elective organisers but will typically take the form of an essay and/or a presentation.

6.1.5 RESIDENTIAL PROGRAMME TRIP TO FIRBUSH OUTDOOR CENTRE

This aspect of the programme aims to allow you to meet and interact with each other early in the programme. It will also provide an opportunity to focus on training in group work and presentations. You will be allocated to small groups at the outset of semester 1 and each group will be provided with a primary research paper on a topic relevant to one of the first two themed weeks. Your group will be required to prepare a poster based on the paper you have been allocated, and you will present this poster (as a group) during a residential programme trip to the University's Firbush Outdoor centre, on the shores of Loch Tay. The poster and your poster presentations are assessed and the marks count for 10 credit points towards the overall mark for the Review of Neuroscience (see Section 6.1.2). Time is set aside during your stay at Firbush for supervised activities (sailing, kayaking, mountain-biking, hill walking etc.) on or around the loch. The trip will be over 3 days and 2 nights during week 6 of the semester; Wed 25th-Fri 27th Oct).

6.1.6 HOME OFFICE TRAINING FOR ANIMAL RESEARCH

Our current neuroscience knowledge is built, in part, on experiments performed using animals and animal tissue. Moreover, many of you will be doing projects which involve the use of animals. Therefore, it is an essential part of the programme is that you understand the ethical and legal framework under which animal research is conducted in the UK. To this end, as part of the core skills and programme sessions we will provide sessions on the use of animals in research and on Home Office licencing. We also require all students on the programme to undergo online training and assessment in the ethics 1

and Legislation elements of the home office training as follows.

17/10/23 Ethics 1 and Legislation Course materials made available on Learn page

17/10/23 – 31/10/23 revise materials

01/11/23 Exam for Ethics 1 and Legislation (online)

If your project involves working with animals, you may need to undertake further relevant training and assessments in order to apply for a Home Office Personal Licence (PIL). We will be in touch with you if you require this training once you have organised your first project. The dates of the additional training are as follows:

20/11/23 PIL AB Rodent, PIL ABF Zebrafish and PIL C surgery course materials made available on Learn page

29/11/23 Any required resits for the E1/L exam 09:30-11:30

29/11/23 PIL AB Rodent or Zebrafish Exam 09:30-11:30

29/11/23 PIL C Surgery Exam 14:00-15:00

04/12/23 PIL exam resits

04/12/23-06/12/23 animal handling 09:00-14:00

07/12/23 PIL C practical 09:30-12:00

18/01/23 NVS Induction 14:00-16:00

If you already have previously held a Home Office Personal Licence, please get in touch with the programme administrator as you may not be required to take all of the courses.

If your project will involve working with zebrafish, please get in touch with the programme administrator as different training will be required.

6.2 RESEARCH PROJECTS

6.2.1 PROJECT RELATED INFORMATION

The aim of the second half of the course is to allow the students to carry out research in an area of their choice, as long as suitable supervision is available. The research period is divided into two blocks, Project 1 and Project 2. Students are **not** automatically assigned to a project. There will be a number of projects available (a list will be posted on LEARN), but you are not limited to these. A list of Edinburgh Neuroscience Research Centres that may be able to accommodate projects can be found Appendix 2 of this handbook. Other researchers at the University of Edinburgh may also be contacted.

6.2.2 CHOOSING A PROJECT

There will be an introductory session in Week 1 of Semester 1 held by Prof Emma Wood and Karen Horsburgh on choosing a project and how best to approach principal investigators. In this session you will discuss which project(s) might be available for you, what techniques and materials they would involve, and what skills and training you will need. Bear in mind that certain projects or Principal

Investigators (PI's) are popular, and some PI's may not have space to accommodate a student. Hence, you may not always be able to work with your first choice of research group. You are advised to contact your preferred PI as soon as possible and to actively follow up on your communications with them. If you would like some help in project selection, contact the Programme Directors (Emma Wood and Karen Horsburgh), the earlier the better.

It is also advisable to apply for more than one project. You should still be selective and focus on those topics that you are most interested in, as you still need to do your research and be prepared for each interview. All research groups are very busy and they have important projects underway all year around; taking on a student often involves shifting resources, time commitments and people, so we expect students to be professional in their communication with potential supervisors. If you get more than one offer, please ensure that as well as accepting one, you also write to decline those you are not taking up, otherwise you may be blocking a potential place for your fellow students.

Many students will continue in the same research group for Project 2. However, if you want to change project start approaching new supervisors as early as practical. You should know by the end of March whether you will be continuing with the same project or not. Please be aware that we cannot guarantee that a particular project listed at the start of the year will still be available for Project 2.

6.2.3 PROJECT DESCRIPTION FORM

Students should aim to finalise their project selection and supervisor by Monday 13th November. This is particularly important for those students whose project involves working with animals, that need to undertake further relevant training and assessments in order to apply for a Home Office Personal Licence (PIL). ~~you~~ You must obtain confirmation in writing (e-mail normally) from the PI who will supervise your project, that you will be able to do your project with them. It is also mandatory that the Project Form (available on Learn) is completed. This includes the project title and an abstract (about 200 words) of the project. This must indicate the **connection of the topic to neuroscience** and that **original data or new insight** will be generated. The abstract can be written jointly by student and supervisor or either, but both need to agree on its content. The form also indicates whether a Home Office Licence is required, and if so, which species of animals will be used, and whether surgery will be required.

Both written confirmation and project description need to be sent to the Programme Administrator for approval by the Programme Directors.

6.2.4 PROJECT ETHICS FORM

Once projects are finalised students are then required to complete a project ethics form (available on LEARN). Guidance on the completion of the ethics form will be outlined in a Q&A project-related session during week 1 semester 2. The ethics form should be completed in discussion with your supervisor and submitted via LEARN by Monday 29th January 2024.

6.2.5 PROJECT 1 RESEARCH PERIOD

Project 1 will commence at the start of Semester 2 and the research period will run between **15th January and 5th April 2024.**

For the first 5 weeks of the project 1 period, you will also be doing the core skills sessions on Monday mornings (see Core Skills section (6.1.3 Page 23)).

6.2.6 PROJECT 1-RELATED ASSESSMENTS

There are two assessments related to Project 1:

- [Research Proposal \(NEBM11007\)](#) – 20 credits.

This comprises a 2,500-word Research Proposal to outline the key background to the research field leading up to your Project, its aims and an outline of how your Project could be extended into a longer 3-year study suitable for a PhD project.

- [Presenting Neuroscience Research Data \(NEBM11005\)](#) – 20 credits.

This comprises preparation and presentation of a poster based on the research you conducted during project 1. Poster presentation.

The Poster will be presented to and discussed with, supervisors, members of the Edinburgh research community and members of the Board of Examiners at the Neuroscience Poster Presentation Day held 18th April.

More details of these assessments provided in sections 6.2.5.1 and 6.2.5.2 below.

6.2.7 RESEARCH PROPOSAL (NEBM11007) – 20 CREDITS

This comprises a research proposal, in which you describe the background including key literature leading up to your Research Project 1 and then an outline of work that would develop your findings from this first project to a longer three-year project suitable for a PhD project. The aim of a research proposal is to put forward a scientific case that a particular research project should be funded. Students may wish to discuss with their project supervisor to gain an understanding of the rationale and feasibility of your ideas for a three-year project. Do not include costings in the research proposal. A Q&A session will be held in semester two on how to formulate and prepare a research proposal. The proposal should be presented with the following sections, and word limits strictly adhered to:

- Introduction and Background, max. 1250 words (not including references, tables or figure legends): Should be a review of the scientific background of the field including key literature. This should provide information required for the project and also highlight where the gaps in knowledge are and how your research proposal addresses these.
- Objectives and Research Plan, max. 1250 words (not including references, tables or figure legends): The Objectives should contain the main scientific hypotheses with an explanation why these are important. The Research Plan should include an outline of the actual experiments including timescales, predicted outcomes and contingency plans.

Referencing should be in the style used by a Neuroscience journal, and should be consistent throughout

Assessment Deadline: An electronic copy should be submitted via LEARN by on **Monday 18th March at 13:00.**

6.2.7.1 RESEARCH PROPOSAL FEEDBACK:

Formative feedback: oral and/or written feedback from your supervisor on a draft version of the research proposal.

Summative feedback: written feedback on your research proposal.

6.2.7.2 PRESENTING NEUROSCIENCE RESEARCH DATA (NEBM11005) – 20 CREDITS

Original research is undertaken in an approved neuroscience research group as part of your Research Project 1 (Jan-April). During this time you develop awareness of a particular research field. You develop and apply research skills to address a particular research question and aims. At the end of your research project 1 you prepare a poster presentation and give a brief oral presentation of your studies based on Research Project 1. General guidance is provided on the preparation of a poster and communication of the findings during a Q&A session in Semester 2.

Poster display (80% marks):

- The poster content should include necessary background, aims/hypotheses/objectives, methodology, results (if any), conclusions, future directions
- General appearance of the poster should be legible, concise, include visual enhancements, well organised and clear.
- Guidance on preparing a poster can be found in Appendix 3.

Oral presentation (20%):

- Each student is allocated 3 min for the presentation and 5 min for discussion and questions.
- Work on the clarity of the presentation and flow of information
- Make sure you understand the subject matter and can respond to questions.

Additional information:

- The poster should be A0 and landscape.
- Printing can be done using the university graphics facilities at George Square or The King's Buildings.
- Up to £20 printing credit will be provided to all students in advance of this.

All posters will be presented during the MScR Integrative Neuroscience poster presentation day on **Thursday 18th April 2024.**

Members of the examination board and other experienced staff will visit the posters in pairs. Students should be prepared to be asked for a quick tour through the poster. Specific points on the poster may be discussed in some depth with the students. This will take about 15-20 minutes and will make up 80% of the poster presentation mark.

Students will then present their work to a small audience made up of markers, members of the

examination board and a subset of their class colleagues. Each student will have three minutes to briefly summarise their studies and will be asked some questions by the audience. This will make up 20% of the poster presentation mark.

6.2.7.3 PRESENTING NEUROSCIENCE RESEARCH DATA FEEDBACK:

Formative feedback: Oral and/or written feedback from your supervisor on a draft version of the poster and oral communication.

Summative feedback: written feedback on your poster and oral communication

6.3 SUMMER PERIOD - PROJECT 2

From 22nd April to 19th July, you will conduct a second 12-week research project on which the dissertation will be based (note there will be a one week break to attend FENS in June). This is often an extension of your first research project, but it can equally be a new project in the same or a different research group, as long as supervision can be arranged. Results from this research will be written up as a dissertation, and also presented in the form of an oral communication in late August. A supervisor report will make up the final piece of assessment.

6.3.1 ASSESSED COMPONENTS OF PROJECT 2

There assessments related to Project 2 are:

[Masters Dissertation \(NEBM11002\)](#) – 80 credits

This comprises a written Dissertation (up to 8,000 words) based on the research project 2.

[Research Training \(NEBM11016\)](#) –20 credits

This is made up of two parts:

- Oral presentation of project 2 (15 credits). This takes the form of an illustrated presentation of your project. Supervisor report of project 2 (5 credits). This comprises a report from the project supervisor on the standard of your laboratory work.

6.3.2 MASTERS DISSERTATION (NEBM11002) – 80 CREDITS

Original research is undertaken in an approved neuroscience research group as part of your Research Project 2 (April-August). It is permissible for this to be an extension of the same project and/or in the same research group as project 1. During this time you develop awareness of a new research field or develop your awareness of a research field related to that in project 1. You develop and apply research skills to address a particular research question and aims. At the end of your research project 2 you prepare a scientific report presented in the form of a dissertation. General guidance is provided on writing your dissertation during a Q&A session in semester 2.

General guidance:

Your Dissertation must consist of an original analysis of a topic in Neuroscience, based on your project work and on published scientific literature.

Abstract is 300 words max

Dissertation text should not exceed 8,000 words, excluding the abstract, a reference list, which may

contain up to 100 references, and any illustrations. Tables are not included in word count. Figure and table legends are not included in the word count.

References should be cited in dissertation text as Name and Year (e.g. Smith et al. 2021).

Reference list (up to 100) should be placed at end of main dissertation text and be in style of Journal of Neuroscience.

We aim for the dissertations to be assessed without knowledge of the student's name. To support this, you should identify your work by Exam Number only and NOT by name on the title page or in headers/footers.

Guidance on structure:

1. Abstract: should give the general problem, your specific hypothesis, your results and conclusions in short form.
2. Introduction: should provide relevant background leading in a clear logical fashion to your aims and hypothesis/es. It should NOT be a general overview of the field. Ask yourself whether specific pieces of information you are giving are relevant to understanding your Aims and hypothesis/es.
3. Aims: should contain a clear hypothesis.
4. Material and Methods: you should describe the methods you used in such a detail that others can replicate your experiments. For qualitative projects this may be an outline of the literature searches and criteria.
5. Results section: should document your results in a logical order. This includes any figures that need to be properly referenced in the text. Figures and Figure legends should be interspersed into the text roughly in the place where they are referenced. For each quantitative analysis it should be reported whether statistical analyses have been performed, which test(s) were used and what the results were. For qualitative projects the results will contain the outcome of your literature review.
6. Discussion: you should critically evaluate your results. How do your data fit previous observations in the literature? Do you have sufficient data to make a clear statement? Which alternative experiments could confirm your results? What are future experiments? For qualitative projects this section will be expected to be more in depth and include an extended "future directions" section that goes beyond the usual discussion.

No hard copies are required – you must only submit a single electronic copy on LEARN. The deadline for the dissertation is on **Monday 5th August 2024 at 13:00.**

6.3.2.1 MASTERS DISSERTATION FEEDBACK

Formative feedback: oral and/or written feedback from your supervisor on a draft version of the research dissertation

Summative feedback: written feedback on your research dissertation

6.3.3 RESEARCH TRAINING (NEBM11016) – 20 CREDITS

Oral presentation of project 2 takes the form of an illustrated presentation. Each student is allocated 15 min on the day, with 10 min for the presentation and 5 min for discussion and questions. This is the same format as for presentations at the Society for Neuroscience. Your marks will consist of 80% for the presentation and 20% for how you answer questions. General guidance is provided on presentations

during a Q&A session in semester 2. Try to arrange a trial presentation with the lab or group that you are working in and use their criticism to make your presentation more effective.

Guidance on preparing for presentations can be found in Appendix 3.

Here are some more pointers as to what the markers will be looking for:

Does the introduction give the necessary background and clearly formulated hypotheses/aims?

Is sufficient methodological detail provided and is the student aware of the limitations of the methods used?

Were the results presented clearly (with figures/tables as appropriate) and analysed appropriately?

Were conclusions clearly defined and supported by the data?

Was there an indication of future work that could be done?

Were questions understood and competently answered?

Overall clarity of speech, timekeeping and relevance of visual aids are also important marking criteria.

Oral presentations will take place on **Monday 19th August 2024**.

6.3.3.1 RESEARCH TRAINING FEEDBACK

Formative feedback: Oral and/or written feedback from your supervisor on a draft version of the oral communication.

Summative feedback: written feedback on your oral communication

6.3.4 DISSERTATION PROJECT AND SUPERVISION

The dissertation/research project is an independent piece of work. You will be allocated a supervisor, who will provide you with advice and guidance in relation to the dissertation/research project, but you should remember that the sole responsibility for the academic quality of your dissertation/research project lies with you. You should research and develop your own ideas and discuss your proposed approaches with your supervisor. Feedback you receive from your supervisor is intended as guidance and must not be interpreted as an indication that your work will receive a particular final mark/outcome. All supervisors are experienced and knowledgeable regarding academic writing.

Regular meetings with your supervisor, normally expected to be fortnightly, will take place during the project and should be determined at the outset. In between meetings, you will be able to contact your supervisor by email.

If you experience any difficulties with your supervision, please contact the Programme Directors, Dr Emma Wood or Prof Karen Horsburgh, in the first instance. Any issues will be treated in confidence and will not be discussed with your supervisor without your agreement.

7. OTHER USEFUL INFORMATION

7.1 OBTAINING LETTERS AND TRANSCRIPTS

Due to the nature of the programme and assessment, it is not possible to obtain an official interim transcript from the University during the course of the programme. Please contact the programme administrator who will write a letter for you with your provisional grades and any other information requested, which you may use. In the past we have had no issue with professional bodies accepting these

letters.

If you require an academic reference, you may ask your project supervisor and/or your programme directors, Emma Wood and Karen Horsburgh.

7.2 INTERNATIONAL CHECK-IN

The [International Check-In](#) is a registration event for new on campus international students. It is necessary to complete the International Check-In to complete the University of Edinburgh matriculation process.

Please refer to the [International Check-In website](#) to ensure you have the correct document to upload, as well as frequently asked questions.

As a Tier 4 student, the University of Edinburgh is the sponsor of your UK visa. The University has a number of legal duties to manage our sponsorship of your visa. These include:

- monitoring your attendance on your programme and
- reporting to the Home Office where you suspend or withdraw from your studies, complete them early, fail to register or are repeatedly absent to the point of being excluded from studies.

As a student with a Tier 4 visa sponsored by the University of Edinburgh, the terms of your visa require you to, (amongst others):

- Ensure you have a correct and valid visa for studying at the University of Edinburgh, which, if a Tier 4 visa, requires that it is a visa sponsored by the University of Edinburgh;
- Attend all of your University classes, seminars, tutorials, etc. where required. This includes participating in the requirements of your course including submitting assignments, attending meetings with tutors and attending examinations. If you cannot attend due to illness, for example, you must inform your School/Deanery.
- PLEASE NOTE that non-attendance and engagement on the programme can result in escalation procedures being followed which can cause serious implications for your visa status and if non-attendance/engagement continues the University may withdraw sponsorship of your visa.

Please note that any email relating to your Tier 4 sponsorship will be sent to your University email address - you should therefore check this regularly and respond promptly.

Further details on the terms and conditions of your Tier 4 visa can be found on the [Student Immigration Service website](#).

The service also has an online enquiry form and an online appointment booking service, accessible [here](#).

7.3 EXPENSE CLAIMS

We will arrange your FENS registration, travel and accommodation. Additionally students are able to claim expenses for food and travel during the conference (budget to be confirmed). Further information will be provided early next year about how to claim for this conference and details about travel/accommodation but all claims must fall within the rules on reimbursement set out in the [University of Edinburgh's Expenses Policy](#).

7.4 CARD ENTRY

For any card entry issues or problems, please contact the relevant building administrator.

7.5 AD-HOC ROOM BOOKINGS

The programme administrator is more than happy to arrange ad-hoc room bookings for you or your colleagues to use, either for class meetings to gather feedback for Student-Staff Liaison Committee meetings, or for practicing your presentations. Please get in touch with the programme administrator to arrange this – note that room bookings are of course based on availability.

7.6 DIGNITY AND RESPECT

The University has a strong and long-standing commitment to equality, diversity and inclusion and to promoting a positive culture which celebrates difference, challenges prejudice and ensures fairness. Our staff and students are our greatest assets and all members of the University community should expect to be able to excel, and to be respected and valued for their unique perspectives and contributions.

Integrity, collegiality and inclusivity are central to the University's values. In accordance with these values the University is committed to providing an environment in which all members of the University community treat each other with dignity and respect, and where bullying, harassment and discrimination are known to be unacceptable. The Dignity and Respect Policy sets out the expectations placed on all members of the University.

A network of [Dignity and Respect Advisors](#) is available for both staff and students to talk to – for information, advice, or support (if, for example, you are being harassed or bullied, or are experiencing any other unacceptable behaviour). If you would like to speak to a Dignity and Respect Advisor contact equalitydiversity@ed.ac.uk

7.7 CODE OF STUDENT CONDUCT

Every student of the University is required to be aware of and adhere at all times to University regulations, policies and codes of practice which relate to student behaviour. When a student fails to observe University rules and regulations, disciplinary action may be taken against them through the procedures set out in the [University's Code of Student Conduct](#), the [academic misconduct investigation procedures](#), or Colleges' 'fitness to practice' procedures (when the behaviour of students on professional programmes raises issues regarding their fitness for entry into the profession).

7.8 STUDENT COMPLAINT PROCEDURE

The [University complaint procedure](#) is designed to ensure that complaints are properly investigated and are given careful and fair consideration.

8. SUPPORT SERVICES AND WELFARE

8.1 STUDENT HEALTH AND WELLBEING

As with all transitions in life, applying to and studying at a university can be both exciting and challenging – whether it is your first time at a university or you are returning to higher education, it is important to look after yourself. University can be busy and stressful at times, this can in turn cause our state of wellbeing to fluctuate. We all have strategies for coping with ups and downs in life and it is important to continue using and revising these skills, to help support and maintain your wellbeing which is crucial to allow you to experience a positive and happy university journey. We provide a range of resources, workshops and support to enable you to cope with the ups and downs of university life. These are provided

by a number of different services, including the Centre for Sport and Exercise, Chaplaincy, Counselling Service and the Edinburgh University Students' Association. We also have the Student Wellbeing Service which will provide wellbeing support, the Equally Safe team to provide support for survivors of gender-based violence, and our online reporting platform Report + Support.

[Health and wellbeing | The University of Edinburgh](#)

[Academic life | The University of Edinburgh](#)

Mental Health & Wellbeing Support at University of Edinburgh

While university life is full of exciting opportunities, it can sometimes be an overwhelming time. Here you can find information to support your physical and mental health and wellbeing.

We have a range of support services to guide you through your university journey, and help to support your wellbeing. These include:

1. Student Advisers/Student support teams/Graduate School staff in Schools and Deaneries
2. [Wellbeing Advisers](#) for you to contact yourself or through your Student Adviser and wellbeing activities in Schools and Deaneries
3. Our [Chaplaincy](#), for all faiths or none, offer The Listening Service 24/7 365 days a year for confidential caring conversations as well as Mindfulness, Yoga, Tai-Chi, PhD bookclub, Writing and Doodling workshops
4. Drop-in groups such as [Skills for Life and Learning](#) run by Student Counselling, [IAD study skills](#), [Disability support groups](#) and Comfort Cafes
5. Keeping active through our [Feel Good Walks](#), [Just Play Sport Sessions](#), and through the various offering of our [Sport & Exercise team](#), including the Pleasance gym, St Leonards Land swimming pool, sports teams, clubs and the [Sports Union](#)
6. [Residence Life](#) provide wellness support for those in University accommodation
7. [Student Counselling Service](#) offer short-term counselling
8. [Disability & Learning Support Service](#) for learning adjustments, mentoring and other specialist support
9. [The Advice Place](#) for independent support and The Student's Association for student societies, peer support, Nightline and Let's Talk campaign & events

IT IS IMPORTANT FOR YOU TO COME FORWARD AND ASK FOR HELP AS EARLY AS POSSIBLE. IF YOU ARE NOT SURE WHAT TO DO, PLEASE CONTACT YOUR STUDENT ADVISER OR YOUR SUPERVISOR AS THE FIRST STEP.

Your Wellbeing

The Student's Health and Wellbeing website provides information on health services, sport and exercise, mental wellbeing and support in a crisis.

During your time in Edinburgh, there may be occasions when you need to see a health care specialist such as a doctor, pharmacist, dentist or optician. A range of health and College of Medicine and Veterinary Medicine supporting services are provided by the University and throughout Edinburgh to help you feel your best.

<http://www.health-service.ed.ac.uk/>

Adapting Well

Information and resources are provided here to help you adapt well and get the best from your University experience, building resilience and coping with change

The Chaplaincy

The Chaplaincy is a safe and welcoming space for people of all faiths and none. All are welcome. The Chaplaincy regularly holds events such as social gatherings and discussions. Weekly events include meditation, prayers, lunches, yoga, tai chi and meetings of the numerous societies who meet here. Chaplain and the Chaplaincy Team; [Chaplaincy | The University of Edinburgh](#)

Telephone: +44 (0)131 650 2595

Email: chaplaincy@ed.ac.uk

Student Counselling

We support the mental health of all students at the University, using short term counselling and referral to other services. We also run presentation workshops on Wellbeing including anxiety management, confidence, managing mood and mindfulness. There are a number of self-help tools including support groups, recommended readings and videos and podcasts. [Student Counselling | The University of Edinburgh](#)

Telephone +44 (0)131 650 4170

Email: student.counselling@ed.ac.uk

Disability and Learning Support Service

The Student Disability Service is a service which supports disabled students. Our main focus is providing advice and support.

We support students with dyslexia, mental health issues and students on the autistic spectrum, as well as those who have physical and sensory impairments. We also work with the rest of the University to improve access in the widest sense. Contact the Student Disability Service about additional funding, disability legislation and policy, building access and additional arrangements for exams.

[Disability and Learning Support Service | The University of Edinburgh](#)

College of Medicine and Veterinary Medicine Student Disability Service

3rd Floor, Main Library, George Square,

Edinburgh, EH8 9LJ

Tel: 0131 650 6828

Email: disability.service@ed.ac.uk

8.2 SUPPORT FOR STUDY

The University of Edinburgh welcomes a diverse student body and aims to support all students throughout their studies. This includes students who have temporary or long-term physical or mental health conditions which may have an adverse impact on their ability to study. The University takes seriously its duty of care to all members of the University community. This policy and procedures are to be followed by staff where the behaviour of a student is giving cause for concern, and where it is believed this may be caused by a mental health problem. The Support for Study Policy applies to all students and to all aspects of University life.

Wellbeing Advisors

Wellbeing Advisors will be available to students who may be experiencing issues impacting on their health, wellbeing, studies and personal lives. These roles will be in place within Schools from the start of the 2022/23 academic year.

You can get support from Wellbeing Advisors, even if just to chat on how you are feeling.

They can provide you with advice and guidance on wellbeing related issues and will also be able to refer you to other services, such as Student Counselling.

You can find out more information on Student Support [here](#)

Health and Safety

The University has a duty, so far as reasonably practicable, to ensure the health, safety and welfare of all employees and students while at work, and the safety of all authorised visitors and members of the public entering the precincts of the University. The University Health and Safety Policy is issued upon the authority of the University Court and contains the Health and Safety Policy statement and summary of the organisation and arrangements of health and safety within the University. The successful implementation of the University Policy requires the support and co-operation of all employees and students – no person shall intentionally interfere with, or misuse anything provided by the University in the interest of health, safety or welfare.

The University Health and Safety Policy

The University Health and Safety Policy is supported by a Framework documents published in two parts on the Organisation and Arrangements of health and safety within the University. Individuals are required to comply with any procedure or arrangements formulated under the authority of this Policy. Any questions or problems about matters of health and safety can be taken up initially with the School Safety Advisor. Further guidance on health and safety matters can be found on the Health and Safety website at <http://www.ed.ac.uk/health-safety/> Including contact details for all professional staff within the corporate Health and Safety Department.

Sport and Exercise

The University of Edinburgh's superb sport and exercise facilities are ranked among the very best in the UK. Catering to a diverse range of users from occasional exercisers to international athletes our state-of-the-art gym and sport offer will allow you to stay active, have fun, try new things and feel your best.

Whether you are looking to work-out or play indoor sport in the heart of Edinburgh at Pleasance Sport Centre & Gym, take part in outdoor sport at Peffermill Playing Fields, take in the scenery and outdoor activities at Firbush Outdoor Centre, try our new gym at the University's Easter Bush Campus, use one of our specialist Swimming or Climbing facilities or need treatment at FASIC Sport & Exercise Medicine Clinic, there really is something for everyone here at Sport & Exercise. So, come Play. Train. Perform!

8.3 EDINBURGH UNIVERSITY STUDENTS' ASSOCIATION

Programme Reps

Programme Reps are the foundations of student representation. They represent the views of peers on their course or programme depending on their School's student representation structure. Programme Reps ensure that academic and support staff are continually listening to and engaging with students to improve the student experience. Ultimately, Programme Reps will work in partnership with staff to improve the student experience for current and future students.

Find out more about the role, available training and how Programme Reps fit into our wider representative structures at eusa.ed.ac.uk/representation

Student Representation

Student representatives – both Programme and Elected Representatives – work closely with staff to ensure your voice is heard on the issues that matter to you, from teaching and learning, to student support, key services, and your sense of belonging to the University community. Throughout the year, representatives will gather feedback from you, share that feedback with relevant staff and other student representatives including the five full-time Sabbatical Officers, and work to enhance your student experience. Your School will facilitate communication between you and your representatives, in-line with this guidance. Student representatives are trained and supported by staff within the Students' Association.

eusa.ed.ac.uk/representation

Student Voice Policy

The Student Voice Policy outlines the University's approach to gathering, learning from and responding to the student voice.

Societies

Societies offer you the chance to develop your interests, network, and meet like-minded people, and at the University of Edinburgh there are over 280 student-led Societies to choose from!

To find a Society for you, visit <https://www.eusa.ed.ac.uk/activities/societies>

Tandem

Language exchange has never been easier. Join us for regular Language Cafes, Speed Lingua evenings and themed events throughout the year or find a language partner for your very own language exchange. Meet other students and practice languages in a fun, relaxed environment without tutors, exams or lectures. All levels welcome!

For more details about Tandem and other Global Students initiatives, check out eusa.ed.ac.uk/global

Peer Learning & Support

Peer Learning and Support in the context of the University means a student with more experience sharing their knowledge, skills, abilities and expertise with a new or less experienced student. Peer Learning and Support Schemes may focus around advancing your academic work, providing 1-2-1 mentoring, or opportunities to socialise with other students within your School or offering additional support to ensure your wellbeing while at University. The Students' Association, in partnership with Schools and University Services, provide some of these opportunities, facilitated by trained student support volunteers, at both the undergraduate and postgraduate level of study at Edinburgh. Other peer support opportunities are also provided by the University. Peer Assisted Learning Schemes (more commonly known as PALS), involve trained volunteers in second year and above who plan and facilitate structured study sessions for other students. These academic sessions cover a variety of topics, including settling into university life, study skills, course content, module choices, assessment and the skills students need to excel in their degrees. Peer Support Schemes (e.g. academic families, buddies, clans or similar) aim to building a sense of community for students, enhance student well-being and enrich the university experience. Peer Support Schemes are based on a model where higher year's students plan and run regular sessions to foster a sense of community and belonging through the integration of the year groups. Sessions can vary depending on the Scheme, but sessions usually have a specific well-being or academic focus, while others provide more social opportunities to facilitate meeting new people. Peer Mentoring Schemes are a form of peer support

that take place in a 1-2-1 environment, whether this is in person or online. Peer Mentoring Schemes usually have a pastoral/welfare or academic focus, however we do also have some identity based Schemes available for example our LGBTQ+ Peer Mentoring Scheme.”

To learn more about your local Peer Learning and Support scheme, or how to set up your own scheme, visit <https://www.eusa.ed.ac.uk/activities/peerlearningsupport>

Peer Proofreading

Powered by student volunteers, the Students’ Association’s Peer Proofreading scheme can check your assignments for any problems with spelling, grammar, and the general clarity of your written English. This scheme is specifically for non-native English-speaking students and you can find out more at <https://www.eusa.ed.ac.uk/adviceplace/academic/proofreading>

The Advice Place

The Advice Place is a professional, impartial and inclusive service for all students at the University of Edinburgh. Our service is free, independent and confidential.

Come and see us in person at Potterrow or King’s Buildings House or ask a question on the online form (via the above link) and we’ll get back to you as soon as possible. The Advice Place provides information advice and – where appropriate- negotiation, advocacy, and referral on the following key areas

- Money and Funding
- Academic- appeals, complaints, course changes and problems
- Benefits
- University Policies and Regulations
- Accommodation
- Personal- health, harassment

More information about the services provided to ODL students can be found on The Advice Place website

How to contact The Advice Place:

Phone - 0131 374 4581

Email - advice@eusa.ed.ac.uk

Website - [Edinburgh University Students' Association](#)

@theadviceplace on twitter and facebook

Careers and Opportunities

[Postgraduates | The University of Edinburgh](#)

The Careers Service provides useful resources and sources of support for helping you make the most of your time at Edinburgh.

You can contact the Careers Service at

phone: +44 (0)131 650 4670

email: careers@ed.ac.uk

<http://twitter.com/uofedcareers>

<http://www.facebook.com/EdinburghCareersService>

English Language Education (ELE)

Online learning (OL) students can access a range of ELE self-study materials, fully accessible online through the University website:

<https://www.ed.ac.uk/english-language-teaching>

On this page you can find resources to help you prepare for study and a list of useful websites.

Further information about ELE services can be found on the main ELE website:

<https://www.ed.ac.uk/english-language-teaching> phone: +44 (0)131 650 6200

email: coladmissions@ed.ac.uk

Money, Fees and Finance

Paying Fees

Income Section contact details Telephone: 44 (0) 131 651 5151 Email: finance.helpline@ed.ac.uk

[Student Academic Fees | The University of Edinburgh](#)

Scholarships and Student Funding

Student funding information, including information for current students who have already commenced their programme of study. [Scholarships and Student Funding | The University of Edinburgh](#)

Development and Alumni

Our role is to work with the academic community to engage alumni, friends, companies and trusts in the life of the University.

We are responsible for sustaining a lifelong relationship with our worldwide alumni community of over 250,000 graduates and raising funds to support students and the University's research and teaching activities. More information can be found [here](#).

Edinburgh Global

Edinburgh Global is the central contact point for international students. It provides all the information and support you need when coming to Edinburgh for your studies, and also provides support for all Edinburgh students going abroad on international experiences.

[Edinburgh Global | The University of Edinburgh](#)

International Students

As a truly global university, we offer a range of specialist services designed to make your move to Edinburgh as smooth as possible.

Further information for Tier 4 visa holders can be found in section 5 above regarding attendance requirements.

Student Administration

[Student Administration](#) are responsible for providing services to all students throughout their time at the University of Edinburgh and for supporting Colleges and Schools and other student services in delivering a high-quality student experience.

The Student Information Point (SIP) team offers official documents for students and graduates.

Email infopoint@ed.ac.uk

Phone +44 (0)131 650 8116

8.4 DATA PROTECTION

Under Data Protection Law, personal data includes all recorded information about a living, identifiable individual. Students using personal data as part of their studies must comply with the responsibilities as outlined in the linked guidance. Before using personal data as part of their studies students must become familiar with the linked guidance, discuss implications with their supervisor and seek appropriate ethics approval. They must also obtain consent from the data subjects to take part in their studies. Failure to comply with the responsibilities is an offence against University discipline, and could lead to a breach of Data Protection Law. A data protection breach can cause distress to the people the information is about, and can harm relationships with research partners, stakeholders, and funding organisations. In severe circumstances the University could be sued, fined up to £20,000,000 and experience reputational damage.

Provide information on local data protection arrangements (including for online distance learning students).

<https://www.ed.ac.uk/data-protection/data-protection-guidance/personal-data-processed-students>

8.5 GLOSSARY

Glossary of Terms

Under the University [Accessible and Inclusive Learning Policy](#), key technical words and/or formulae shall be provided to students at least 24 hours in advance of the class. Where there are words and terms not listed here, the Programme Team will provide these at least 24 hours prior to each tutorial taking place.

APPENDIX 1: RECOMMENDED READING

Recommended:

- Bear, M.F., Connors, B. and Paradiso, M. (2015), *Neuroscience: Exploring the Brain* (International Edition). Lippincott Williams & Wilkins.

Or

- Nicholls, J. G. and Martin, A. R. (2012), *From Neuron to Brain* (Fifth Edition). Sinauer Associates.

Not essential but may be of interest to develop interests:

- Carpenter, R.H.S. and Reddi, B. (2012), *Neurophysiology: A Conceptual Approach* (Fifth Edition). CRC Press.
 - Well-written, systems orientated.
- Crossman, A.R. & Neary, D. (2014), *Neuroanatomy: An Illustrated Colour Text*. Churchill Livingstone.
 - Introductory neuroanatomy.
- Kandel, E.R., Schwartz, J.H., Jessell, T. M., Siegelbaum, S.A. and Hudspeth, A.J. (2012), *Principles of Neural Science* (Fifth Edition). McGraw-Hill Medical.
 - Comprehensive, polished overview of systems and cellular neuroscience.
- Longstaff, A. (2011), *BIOS Instant Notes in Neuroscience*. Taylor & Francis.
 - A very useful reference for non-neuroscientists and neuroscientists alike.
- Price, D., Jarman, A.P., Mason, J.O., Kind, P.C. (2011), *Building Brains: An Introduction to Neural Development* (First Edition). Wiley-Blackwell.
 - Very didactic book that does exactly what the title says.
- Shepherd, G. M. (2004), *The Synaptic Organization of the Brain* (Fifth Edition). Oxford University Press Inc.
 - Quite advanced; focus on structure/function relationships in selected regions of the CNS.

Statistics:

You will be introduced to relevant statistical methods as part of the taught component of the programme (core skills) but if further reading required recommend:

Analysis of biological data Whitlock M. & Schluter D. (An introductory biological statistics textbook including worked examples)

The Institute of Academic Development (IAD) also offers two online courses in statistics:

<http://www.ed.ac.uk/schools-departments/institute-academic-development/postgraduate/doctoral/courses/online-courses/stats>

APPENDIX 2: LIST OF RESEARCH CENTRES

<u>Centre for Discovery Brain Sciences</u> The Centre for Discovery Brain Sciences explores fundamental physiological mechanisms and pathways, from single genes to complex behaviour. https://discovery-brain-sciences.ed.ac.uk/	<u>Centre for Clinical Brain Sciences</u> CCBS is a multidisciplinary translational "centre without walls" combining basic and applied research to study the causes, consequences and treatment of major brain disorders. Their major disease areas, that straddle the disciplines of Neurology and Psychiatry, include: autism, dementias, bipolar disorders, brain cancer, epilepsy, multiple sclerosis, motor neurone disease, prion disease, schizophrenia, stroke and synaptic biology & disease. Director: Colin Smith, Professor of Neuropathology http://www.ccbs.ed.ac.uk/
<u>UK Dementia Research Institute (DRI) Edinburgh</u> Focuses on understanding how all the different cell types in our brains work together to keep the brain healthy, how this goes wrong in dementia, and how this process can be slowed or stopped to alter disease progression. Director: Prof Giles Hardingham https://ukdri.ac.uk/centres/edinburgh	<u>Simons Institute for the Developing Brain</u> A "virtual centre" bringing together over 30 principal investigators across 6 research sites. Working to discover the biological mechanisms underlying autism. (Sister institute to the Patrick Wild Centre) http://sidb.org.uk
<u>Centre for Cardiovascular Science</u> CCVS fosters and delivers internationally leading research into the causes, consequences and therapy of cardiovascular diseases. Research is investigator-led, but there are focal disease themes which span from the origins and risk factors for the development of atherosclerosis to the factors which determine tissue recovery from ischaemia. Research themes include control of circadian and neuroendocrine rhythms. Director: Andrew Baker, Gustav Born Chair of Vascular Biology. http://www.cvs.ed.ac.uk/	<u>Institute for Genetics and Cancer</u> The Institute of Genetics and Cancer is a strategic partnership of the MRC Human Genetics Unit (HGU), Edinburgh Cancer Research, and the Centre for Genomic and Experimental Medicine that together form a coalition of distinct world class expertise in genetics and cancer. The IGCancer is tackling one of the greatest biomedical challenges, determining how mutations – constitutional and acquired - drive the molecular and cellular dysfunction that result in disease. https://www.ed.ac.uk/institute-genetics-cancer

<u>Clinical Psychology</u> Based in the College of Humanities and Social Sciences, Clinical Psychology has strengths in ageing and older adulthood, brain injury, chronic health conditions, cognitive behavioural interventions, emotions and emotion regulation, sex offenders, learning disability, neuropsychology, quality of life, severe and enduring mental health, and in the development and validation of measures. Director: Matthias Schwannauer https://www.ed.ac.uk/health/subject-areas/clinical-psychology	<u>Informatics - Institute for Adaptive and Neural Computation</u> Located within the College of Science and Engineering, members of the IANC are interested in neuroinformatics and participate in collaborative work involving the traditional disciplines of neuroscience, cognitive science, computer science, computational science, mathematics and statistics. Director: Dr Nigel Goddard, Reader in Informatics http://www.anc.ed.ac.uk/
<u>Institute for Music in Human and Social Development</u> Located within the College of Humanities and Social Sciences, the Institute for Music in Human and Social Development brings together research and practice from a range of disciplines including music, psychology, neuroscience, informatics, sociology, linguistics, education and medicine. Directors: Dr. Katie Overy, Senior Lecturer in Music https://www.eca.ed.ac.uk/research/music-human-and-social-development-research-group	<u>Psychology</u> Based in the College of Humanities and Social Sciences, Psychology has organised its research along three broad themes: Differential Psychology, Human Cognitive Neuroscience and Language, Cognition and Communication. It also hosts the Centre for Cognitive Ageing and Cognitive Epidemiology (see above). Head: Dr Rob McIntosh https://www.ed.ac.uk/ppls
<u>The Roslin Institute</u> The Division of Neurobiology at the Roslin Institute studies the key mechanisms that preserve healthy brain function and those that contribute to neurodegeneration. It encompasses a world- leading centre for the study of human and animal transmissible spongiform encephalopathies (prion diseases). Director: David Hume, Professor of Mammalian Functional Genomics and Research http://www.roslin.ed.ac.uk/	<u>Alzheimer Scotland Dementia Research Centre</u> Alzheimer Scotland Dementia Research Centre is in partnership with the University of Edinburgh and provides a high-quality environment for dementia research. The facility provides a high-quality research environment for investigations into the causes and treatment of dementia, and care provided by relatives and friends. It aims to commission and build a balanced portfolio of scientific and clinical research and develop and maintain a dementia brain tissue bank. Director: Dr Tom Russ http://www.alzscotdrc.ed.ac.uk/

<u>Anne Rowling Regenerative Neurology Clinic</u> The Anne Rowling Regenerative Neurology Clinic is a charitable University of Edinburgh research facility focusing on a wide range of neurological conditions, especially neurodegenerative diseases. Neurodegenerative diseases represent one of the major public health threats in the industrialised world. These diseases include multiple sclerosis (MS), motor neurone disease (MND or ALS), Parkinson's disease and related conditions and dementias. It aims to improve patients' lives through research: translating laboratory findings into clinical trials and ultimately, new therapies. Director: Siddharthan Chandran, MacDonald Professor of Neurology https://www.annerowlingclinic.org/about	<u>Euan MacDonald Centre for Motor Neurone Disease Research</u> The Euan MacDonald Centre is a "centre without walls" of 30 researchers across Scotland that seeks to improve the lives of patients living with MND through fundamental discovery research as well as a growing portfolio of patient-centred research projects. Director: Siddharthan Chandran, MacDonald Professor of Neurology http://www.euanmacdonaldcentre.org/
<u>Muir Maxwell Epilepsy Centre</u> The mission of the Muir Maxwell Epilepsy Centre is to investigate the causes and consequences of epilepsy and to develop the very best treatments for those children and families affected by the condition by fostering collaborations between world-class basic scientists and clinical researchers at the University and beyond. Director: Dr Richard Chin, Clinical Senior Lecturer	<u>MRC Centre for Regenerative Medicine</u> MRC-CRM brings together world leading basic stem cell research with established clinical excellence to deliver a "bench-to-bedside" approach aimed at developing new treatments for major diseases including cancer, heart disease, diabetes, degenerative diseases such as multiple sclerosis and Parkinson's disease, and liver failure. Director: Professor Stuart Forbes http://www.crm.ed.ac.uk/

APPENDIX 3: BMTO WORD LIMIT AND PENALTIES POLICY

1. Penalties for exceeding the word limit

Where an absolute word limit is specified in assessment documentation the following penalties will be applied if the word limit is exceeded.

- Exceeding word count by $\leq 10\%$: 10% deduction of the maximum mark or a reduction to the minimum pass mark for the assignment, whichever results in the higher mark.
- Exceeding word count by $>10\%$ and $\leq 20\%$: 20% deduction of the maximum mark or a reduction to the minimum pass mark for the assignment, whichever results in the higher mark.
- Exceeding word count by $> 20\%$: mark reduced to the minimum pass mark for the assignment.

2. What is and is not included in the word limit.

- When evaluating the word count it **does not** include the assignment title, table of contents, references, text in figures, text in tables, table and figure titles, table and figure legends, a list of abbreviations or any acknowledgements.
- The word limit **does include** in-text citations (where Harvard referencing is required), headings and sub-headings.
- The use of appendices is not an allowable mechanism for exceeding the maximum word limit. Therefore, unless otherwise stated in the assignment guidance, material included in an appendix will be regarded as non-assessable and will not be considered by the markers/examiners when arriving at a final mark.

Additional Guidance

Figures and Tables

With regard to words in figure and / or diagram legends, a figure legend is primarily descriptive of the contents of the figure. The legend must not be used to introduce new data or information not referred to in the main text of the assignment. Tables should be used to summarise several pieces of information in a succinct and easily approachable manner. As such, figure legends that go beyond the description of figure contents and unnecessarily extensive tables will not be regarded favourably by markers.

Attempts to deliberately circumvent the word limit through, for example, inappropriate hyphenation, including blocks of text as picture images, etc. will be regarded as potential academic misconduct and referred to the Deanery Academic Misconduct Officer.

3. How the policy will be applied.

- Students will be required to indicate the total word count on the assignment cover sheet. Where a word limit is specified, word counts will be checked by the course administrator by opening submissions in MS Word and removing all sections not included in the final word limit. The word count then specified in MS Word will be taken as the final word count.

APPENDIX 4: GENERAL GUIDELINES ON PRESENTATIONS

BETTER POSTERS

Posters are in landscape format, and A0 size (841 × 1189 mm). While this may seem like a large area, the format is surprisingly restrictive. Careful design is essential.

- The poster is primarily a visual display. Begin by preparing a scale model layout as an outline for the poster. This allows you to determine the number and size of figures, tables, headings and length of text before making any final products.
- The organisation and flow of the poster needs to be very clear. Visually subordinate those things that are less important and draw attention to those of greater importance. Make clear the sequence in which the poster is to be viewed.
- Keep explanatory text close to the figure it is explaining. Group related information together, and make the groupings clear, perhaps by surrounding each group with some blank space and labelling them with a heading. A visually clear presentation will have a substantial amount of blank space. If elements are crammed too tightly, the poster will appear chaotic and be hard to follow.
- Show rather than tell the story. Tables and figures should hold the main content of a successful poster. Graphics must dominate. Do not use extensive text. Edit ruthlessly. It may help to have someone else help edit, since they are less emotionally attached to your work.
- Use a simple font, such as Helvetica. A mix of caps and lower case is easier to read than all caps.
- The title should be legible from 5-7m away (type > 25 mm high). It should be assertive, clear, and catch the eye of the viewer.
- Concisely state the main conclusion. Leave the reader no doubts about the take-home message.
- Posters are on display for several hours, and therefore they allow time for lengthy discussion with colleagues. Be prepared to answer questions and discuss ideas with the poster viewers. Some viewers may ask you to identify the key ideas you are trying to convey, so it is helpful to think about what to say as a brief introductory overview of the poster to open the discussion.

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

Some tips that will help you give a better talk:

- Plan your talk carefully around a few “take home messages.”
- Most people agree that you can package one or two main ideas or “bullets” per fifteen minutes in an oral presentation. Choosing your “bullet” ideas carefully will focus your talk. Make your main ideas clear to the audience.
- Practice your talk: often, both alone and in front of critical friends. Friends outside your area of expertise will be especially good at catching undefined or unclear jargon.

- Pay special attention to highly technical or novel items, to make sure that you convey these clearly and concisely to an audience who may not have come across them before.
- Avoid distracting mannerisms, such as waving the pointer or pacing.
- Talk to your audience, do not read to them.
- Know your talk well enough to give it, without notes, in easy-to-follow conversational sentences. If necessary, bring your notes to the podium for security, but if you know your talk well enough, it will come automatically despite your nervousness. Remember, your slides or overheads will serve as a visual outline to help you through your talk.
- Use a loud clear, enthusiastic voice. If you don't seem to care about your topic, why should your audience?

EFFECTIVE SLIDES

The cardinal rule for making slides is to include only the relevant information and to make sure your audience can read your slides.

- Include only necessary information on slides.
- Avoid tables but, if necessary, simplify them by including only the data you will need to make your point.
- Use numbers with only a few significant digits; round if necessary. If there is some graphical way to present the same information, do so, because your audience will be more likely to grasp it.
- Include on each slide only information that you will discuss. Other information is distracting and confusing. Limit each slide to one main idea, and just a few sentences.
- Make sure your slides are readable. Font sizes of 18-24pt seem to work well in most cases.
- Slides with light backgrounds may be more legible than slides with dark backgrounds, particularly if any room light is present. Most computer-generated slides project much darker than they appear on the computer screen. Choose colour combinations that contrast well, and remember that there will be colour-blind people in the audience.
- Organise your slideshow. If you refer to the same slide more than once, use duplicates. Do not torment the audience by "rewinding" or "fast-forwarding" through your slides to find the one you want to recall.
- If you have a lot to say about a table or figure, reproduce it and highlight the specific parts you'll talk about in turn. This will pace your talk as well, rather than having your talk stall on a single slide.
- Horizontal slides are best, since the size of the screen may result in cropped vertical slides. In addition, viewers at the rear of the audience in a large room will probably not be able to see the bottom of vertical slides.

APPENDIX 5: GENERAL GUIDELINES ON DISSERTATIONS

A first class dissertation (Distinction) should be an original analysis, that is clearly presented, cogently argued, critical, rigorous, balanced, and authoritative. It should also contain evidence of originality of thought and/or analysis of your own data or others published data.

Presentation: The style should be concise yet fluent. It should be readily understood, and enjoyed, by an interested neuroscientist who is not an expert in the particular topic of the dissertation. Illustrations should be carefully selected to amplify the text appropriately. The minimum font size should be 11pt.

Cogently argued: The dissertation should have a clear structure. The topic should be introduced thoughtfully, displaying an awareness of the history of the evolution of relevant concepts or ideas, and developed carefully and convincingly.

Critical: The dissertation should make clear what experimental evidence underlies key points in the argument; you should show a keen awareness of the strengths and limitations of the available experimental evidence, including your own.

Balanced: You should show an appreciation of alternative interpretations of the evidence; inconsistencies or omissions in the evidence – including your own original data – should be exposed and, if possible, resolved through a process of critical consideration.

Rigorous: Conclusions at each stage of the analysis should be drawn logically from this experimental evidence available. The material included in the thesis should be relevant and necessary for the development of this logical process. Quantitative data should be subject to appropriate numerical and/or statistical analysis.

Authoritative: The references chosen should appropriately reflect the best work done on the topic of the dissertation; they should be carefully selected and accurately cited. Many more papers will have been read than are eventually cited.

Originality: The examiners will be looking for a display of originality in any of the above aspects, and indeed a dissertation that fully satisfies the above may be deemed to be highly original on this basis alone, assuming that the elements of the dissertation do not simply comprise a compilation or re-statement of arguments and statements available in the published literature. You may also display originality in other ways, for instance by drawing novel analogies or comparisons between systems or between phenomena, or by suggesting a route for further investigation to test a key hypothesis in the argument, or by proposing a novel hypothesis or explanation.

Originality in all of these aspects must be tempered by the absolute need to retain a critical rigour in all that is written.

PREPARING YOUR DISSERTATION

Your supervisor is allowed to give you advice on the presentation and content of the dissertation. You are therefore strongly urged to seek your supervisor's opinion on a first draft of the dissertation. They will point out any fundamental flaws in the approach and the methods of data analysis. You

are advised to submit your first draft for appraisal by your supervisor not later than two weeks before the submission deadline for the final version.

Submission: You will submit electronically on LEARN. Please ensure your dissertation is in PDF and a maximum file size of 20 MB (megabytes).

Marking: A dissertation which displays minor errors or omissions, or minor flaws in presentation, may still satisfy the examiners as being of a first class (Distinction) standard overall.

Cover Sheet: You must attach a cover sheet to your dissertation. You will find this on the LEARN page. Please use your **exam number**, which will be emailed to you during the course of the semester.

APPENDIX 6 - POSTGRADUATE COMMON MARKING SCHEME

Mark (%)	Grade	Description
90-100	A1	An excellent performance, satisfactory for a distinction
80-89	A2	An excellent performance, satisfactory for a distinction
70-79	A3	An excellent performance, satisfactory for a distinction
60-69	B	A very good performance
50-59	C	A good performance, satisfactory for a masters degree
40-49	D	A satisfactory performance for the diploma and certificate, but inadequate for a masters degree
30-39	E	Marginal Fail
20-29	F	Clear Fail
10-19	G	Bad Fail
0-9	H	Bad Fail

APPENDIX 7 – USEFUL WEB PAGES

New Student's website	https://www.ed.ac.uk/students/new-students
Checklist to Getting Started at Edinburgh	https://www.ed.ac.uk/students/new-students/ready-university
IT and Library Guide	https://www.ed.ac.uk/information-services/library-museum-gallery
Postgraduate Information	https://www.ed.ac.uk/studying/postgraduate

Deanery of Biomedical Sciences	http://www.ed.ac.uk/biomedical-sciences/
Biomedical Teaching Organisation	http://www.ed.ac.uk/biomedical-sciences/bmto
University of Edinburgh Computing Services	http://www.ed.ac.uk/information-services/computing
British Neuroscience Association	http://www.bna.org.uk/
Federation of European Neuroscience Societies (FENS)	http://www.fens.org/
American Society for Neuroscience	http://www.sfn.org/
Neurosciences on the Internet	http://www.neuroguide.com/